

Killer rigs

A PC can be of any configuration and price point. We do exactly that, list out set combinations at different prices.

content provider or the other and have become exclusive – a word I've come to hate for quite some time.

So I'm not going to jump the gun this time. All three competitors seem to show promise but within the first few months of their release we will see the market starting to favour one among the three. And I'm hoping it might be the SteamVR and most probably I can kiss goodbye to all the new upgrades I'd planned.

P.S. - The year might be 2017...

Gaming laptop for ₹40,000

Hi Team Digit,

I have a mid 2011 MacBook Air and am thinking of getting a gaming laptop. My budget is around ₹40,000. Please suggest a good laptop. Also in the May issue of SKOAR! The article on the death of gaming consoles had a table comparing the next generation consoles to a PC. Could you please send me the rig and the price. Thanking you in advance.

– Dhimant Ananmay

A Gaming at ₹40k is not an ideal scenario at all. Laptops being a more portable package than desktops, offer a lot less in terms of performance for the same price. Moreover, laptops available at this price point aren't designed to withstand the generous amount of heat generated during gaming. So you'll be reducing the life of your laptop by a sizeable margin if you run resource heavy games for extended periods. You can game as long as you are careful about temperatures. Run a temperature monitoring utility in the background like RealTemp or even Speccy for that



ASUS X555LJ-XX177H

matter since it records temperature over time. If the average temperature recorded during your gaming sessions are way higher than 60 degrees then you need to ease up on the graphics settings. This process may be a little tedious but it will help. As far as recommendations go, there are very few

WHAT YOU LEARN FROM MAKING GAMES

Games bring out the best in people. Their problem-solving skills are put to the test. If there was ever a challenge players of a good game relished, it was finding out the answers to a problem posed to them by another human being. A system built by other people proves far more engaging than beaten-up forms of linear mental stimulation.

As a designer, the skill set lies in posing new challenges creatively and in posing existing fictional and real-world challenges differently. This skillset had already been perfected by the time games were being considered for use in solving real-world issues - at first to train commercial jet pilots in being attentive to take-off, landing, in-flight and radio procedures; then to train regular people to drive, and enforcing civil behaviour among drivers by giving them immediate feedback on their performance in simulated environments; and finally to achieve major scientific breakthroughs.

Through hours spent in play, a 2010-developed app called Foldit gave scientists the data they required to solve a medical problem that baffled them for over 13 years. In three weeks, players resolved the structure of an enzyme causing recurring HIV in monkeys, all by puzzles translated

from protein-structure to on-screen spatial problems. The human mind has the innate ability to recognize patterns and solve what doesn't sit right with its logical side. Taking advantage of these puzzle-solving intuitions and encouraging competitive gameplay to fold the best proteins, they were able to reach a cure in a short span of time.

Another such example, Planet Hunters, has players interact with the universe to discover and explore entirely new solar systems in search of planets. The collaboration of scientists and gamers has not only allowed them to accelerate research enough to spend time on the right things, but it also gave them the work-force they needed to make consistent breakthroughs for the good of humanity.

When designers let go and watch their games at work, they find many immediate fixes and improvements that would otherwise not have been possible. So if you're a designer or are looking into the industry as a student or a non-gamer, this is what you need to know. Forget pressure and panic, and embrace play with open-mindedness. As gaming flourishes in the fields of astronomical and scientific research, game designers will soon internalize the skill of creating compelling games that push players' problem-solving capabilities to the next level.

For more visit www.dsk.digit.in.



Gaming teaches you lots of things